disciplined approach to configuration management of the schema for your database.

You learned how to create, rename, and delete columns and tables, to manage indices and keys, to apply and back out entire sets of changes, and even to add your own custom SQL into the mix, all in a completely reproducible manner.

At this point we've covered the externals of Rails. The next chapter is going to show a few more involved ways of customizing Rails to demonstrate just how flexible Rails can be when you need it. We'll see how to use RSpec for testing, use Slim instead of ERB for templating, and use Webpack to manage your CSS.

Footnotes

[168] http://guides.rubyonrails.org/active_record_migrations.html#schema-dumping-and-you

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